

B.T. Franklin

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Professional Summary

Principal engineer and software architect with 20+ years building enterprise software, developer tools, and product-facing systems. Combines hands-on agentic AI, platform architecture, full-stack engineering, technical leadership, and published computational creativity research.

Professional Experience

ManageAI

Founding Principal Engineer

February 2026 - Present

- Use an AI-first approach for all engineering work, directing coding agents and agentic workflows to build applications, services, and complex AWS infrastructure.
- Built a Django, PostgreSQL, and HTMX platform to manage customer AI workforces, deployments, evaluations, and governance.
- Designed tenant-scoped APIs and agent record publishers with capability-based access, idempotent operations, and audit history.
- Built Knowledge services with HTTP and MCP access, immutable revisions, human approval, and controlled publication.
- Built customer-specific AWS deployments with Terraform, staging validation, guarded data transfers, and rollback safeguards.

Zilliant, Inc.

AI Tech Lead / Staff Software Engineer

April 2025 - July 2026

- Guided engineering teams on LLMs, agents, evaluation practices, and modern AI development aligned with business goals.
- Architected and shipped a customer-facing read-only data API in less than one month, earning a delivery bonus; then refactored Pricing Plus data access behind semantic adapters.
- Led and prototyped an AWS offering built with the Strands Agents SDK for conversational exploration of pricing formulas.
- Architected the company's first MCP server and tools for retrieving calculated prices and explaining formula reasoning.

Software Architect

August 2022 - March 2025

- Built a generative AI pipeline that integrated diverse pricing insights into customer-facing analytics in real time.
- Led and shipped an AWS QuickSight and Amazon Q integration with embedded visualization and AI-assisted analysis.
- Designed and launched the Zilliant Developer Experience CLI, reducing complex environment migrations from multiple days to a few hours.
- **Earlier Zilliant progression (2009-2022):** Staff Software Engineer (2020-2022) and Senior Software Engineer (2009-2019), spanning architecture, product modernization, and mentorship.

Selected Independent and Open Source AI Work

- Built and deployed independent AI applications with structured extraction, semantic matching, background processing, and subscription billing.
- **Open source AI tooling:** Created contract4agents, agentic-django, compendiumscribe, promptdown, release-notes-scribe, and reusable agent skills.

Research and Publications

Published computational creativity research on AI-driven storytelling and generative music in the *Proceedings of Generative Art Conference* and *Computer Simulation of Musical Creativity Conference*.

Education

Transylvania University, Lexington, KY: BA in Computer Science, 1997.

Skills

Python; JavaScript/TypeScript; OpenAI and Anthropic APIs; Agentic Systems; MCP; RAG; Structured Extraction; Semantic Search; Strands and OpenAI Agents SDKs; AWS; Terraform; Django; PostgreSQL; HTMX; React; Next.js; Node.js; API and Platform Design; Multi-Tenant Architecture; AI Governance; Background Processing; Evaluation; Technical Strategy.